When Does a Home Repair Need a Permit? Ada & Canyon County

Quick reference for Treasure Valley homeowners. When in doubt, one phone call to the building department settles it.

Usually NO permit (typical handyman scope)

- Painting, caulking, and cosmetic finishes
- Drywall patching and texture repair
- Like-for-like fixture swaps: faucets, toilets, light fixtures, outlets
- Cabinet, trim, door, and hardware repair or replacement
- Fence repair and like-for-like section replacement (height rules apply to new fences)
- Deck board and rail repair (not structural framing)
- Gutter cleaning and repair; TV mounting, shelving, assembly

Usually YES, permit required (licensed-trade territory)

- New electrical circuits, panel work, or service changes
- Moving or adding plumbing (not like-for-like swaps)
- Water heater replacement (permit required in most jurisdictions)
- Structural changes: removing walls, headers, deck framing and ledgers
- Additions, ADUs, and garage conversions
- Re-roofs and most HVAC equipment replacement
- Gas line work of any kind

Who to call

If your home is in	County	Ask
Boise, Meridian, Eagle	Ada	Your city building dept, o…
Kuna, Star	Ada	Your city building dept, o…
Nampa, Caldwell, Middleton	Canyon	Your city building dept, o…

Homeowner checklist

[ ] Confirm the jurisdiction (city vs unincorporated county) before asking

[ ] Describe the actual work: "like-for-like swap" vs "moving/adding" changes the answer

[ ] HOA approval, where it applies, is separate from any permit

[ ] Permits protect resale: unpermitted work surfaces at inspection time

[ ] A pro who shrugs at permits for permit-level work is a red flag

Learn more

- Visual guide: https://boisehandyman.co/resources/ada-canyon-permit-flow
- Article: https://boisehandyman.co/blog/ada-vs-canyon-county-permit-timelines
- Hiring guide: https://boisehandyman.co/guides/hire-a-handyman-treasure-valley